

01

CURRENT SCHOLARLY ANCHOR — [SUPPORTING]

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Current scholarly anchor — [SUPPORTING]: □□ Inference: Neural mediation does not by itself prove either veridicality or illusion.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□□ Inference: Neural mediation does not by itself prove either veridicality or illusion.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

It explains a mechanism or correlate; the philosophical question of the experience's object and warrant remains open.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□□ Inference: Neural mediation does not by itself prove either veridicality or illusion.

ANSWER LINE: □ **Fact: A 2025 Frontiers in Neuroscience review described neuroscience of religion as the study of correlations between brain functions and religious practices, beliefs and experiences, while emphasizing methodological and definitional limitations.**

02

VISUAL GATEWAY — ASK THREE QUESTIONS IN ORDER

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Visual gateway — ask three questions in order: Recommended opening definition: Religious experience is an experience interpreted as disclosing or relating the subject to an ultimate, sacred or divine reality.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Recommended opening definition: Mystical experience is a mode of religious experience marked, for William James, primarily by ineffability and noetic quality.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Core argument/criticism: Unlike episodic subject-object encounter, non-dual realisation claims to dissolve the distinction between knower and known and to become stable knowledge.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Equally, conceptual or neural mediation does not automatically make it fabricated.

ANSWER LINE: **Master rule: A vivid or transformative experience can be psychologically real without its interpretation being automatically true.**